Sewing Kit Starter Checklist

Everything a beginner actually needs is here — two punchy pages of shopping and a supply list that fits in one tin. Check each box as you tick it off in the store.

The full kit (grab these first)

- [ ] **Sewing scissors** — a small pair dedicated to fabric (don't use them on paper; paper dulls them)
- [ ] **Hand needles** — one variety pack of sharps, sizes 5–10
- [ ] **All-purpose thread** — two spools: one black, one white, plus one in the color you wear most
- [ ] **Heavy-duty thread** — for denim, bags, and anything that takes strain
- [ ] **Straight pins** + a little tin or wrist pincushion to keep them in (magnets love pins, and so do bare feet if you don't)
- [ ] **Needle threader** — a couple cents of wire that saves a half hour now and then. They break; buy two.
- [ ] **Measuring tape** — soft, flexible, sewist's style
- [ ] **Thimble** — one that fits the middle finger of your sewing hand snugly
- [ ] **Seam ripper** — for unpicking stitches; it is the most-used tool in my drawer
- [ ] **Safety pins** — a small mixed pack; they also handle fallen-hem rescues
- [ ] **Beeswax or thread wax** — run thread through it once to stop knots and tangles

Nice to have (second visit)

- [ ] **Iron-on patch assortment** — knees and elbows will thank you
- [ ] **Iron and ironing board or pressing mat** — if you don't already own one, a mini steam iron works fine
- [ ] **Fabric scraps bag** — anything 4 inches or bigger, keep in a shoebox for patching
- [ ] **Wonder Clips or binder clips** — hold layers without poking you
- [ ] **Fray-check liquid** — seals raw edges without sewing (great for fallen hems)
- [ ] **Regular dyed buttons** — a $3 jar of spare buttons saves any button pop-off
- [ ] **Storage tin or box** — any flat tin will do. If it lives in one predictable place, you'll actually mend things.

Kind tips: A sewing starter kit is cheap. It's not a hobby budget; it's about the same as one pair of pants. Once you own it, every fix after that costs thread and elbow grease.